

World & International Organizations — Complete Notes

For: ETEA | KPPSC | FPSC | FIA | NTS | CSS | PMS Preparation

SECTION 1: UNITED NATIONS (UN)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** United Nations
- **Abbreviation:** UN
- **Founded:** 24 October 1945 (UN Day)
- **Charter Signed:** 26 June 1945, San Francisco, USA
- **Headquarters:** New York City, USA
- **Founding Members:** 51 nations
- **Current Members:** 193 member states
- **Current Secretary-General:** António Guterres (Portugal) — since January 2017
- **First Secretary-General:** Trygve Lie (Norway, 1946–1952)

Background & Formation

- The UN replaced the failed **League of Nations** (1919–1946)
- League of Nations could not prevent World War II, leading to its dissolution
- The name "United Nations" was coined by US President Franklin D. Roosevelt
- The UN Charter was negotiated at the San Francisco Conference (April–June 1945)
- The Charter came into force on 24 October 1945 — this date is celebrated as **UN Day**

Six Principal Organs of the UN

1. **General Assembly (GA)** — Main deliberative body; all 193 members represented; meets annually
2. **Security Council** — Primary body for international peace & security; 15 members (5 permanent + 10 non-permanent)
3. **Secretariat** — Administrative organ; headed by the Secretary-General
4. **International Court of Justice (ICJ)** — Principal judicial organ; located in **The Hague, Netherlands**
5. **Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)** — Coordinates economic, social, and related work
6. **Trusteeship Council** — Suspended operations in 1994 after independence of Palau

UN Security Council

- **Total Members:** 15 (5 permanent + 10 non-permanent)
- **Permanent Members (P5) with Veto Power:** USA, United Kingdom, France, Russia, China
- Non-permanent members are elected for 2-year terms by the General Assembly
- P5 members can veto any substantive resolution
- Pakistan has been a non-permanent member several times

Key UN Facts

- **Official Languages:** 6 — Arabic, Chinese, English, French, Russian, Spanish
- **Working Languages:** English and French
- **UN Flag:** Light blue background with white UN emblem
- **UN Headquarters:** New York (main); Geneva (Europe HQ); Vienna; Nairobi
- **ICJ Location:** The Hague, Netherlands — NOT New York
- **Budget:** Assessed contributions from member states; USA pays the largest share

Major UN Agencies & Their Locations

Agency	Full Name	Location
WHO	World Health Organization	Geneva, Switzerland
UNESCO	UN Educational, Scientific & Cultural Org.	Paris, France
UNICEF	UN Children's Fund	New York, USA
UNHCR	UN High Commissioner for Refugees	Geneva, Switzerland
FAO	Food & Agriculture Organization	Rome, Italy
ILO	International Labour Organization	Geneva, Switzerland
IAEA	International Atomic Energy Agency	Vienna, Austria
WFP	World Food Programme	Rome, Italy

Pakistan & the UN

- Pakistan joined the UN on **30 September 1947** (soon after independence)
- Pakistan has contributed significantly to UN Peacekeeping Forces
- Pakistan has been elected as non-permanent Security Council member multiple times
- Pakistan is a member of the G-77 group within the UN

Key Treaties/Events Related to UN

- **Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR):** Adopted 10 December 1948
- **Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT):** Opened for signature 1968
- **Kyoto Protocol:** 1997 (climate change)
- **Paris Agreement:** 2015 (climate change)
- **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs):** 17 goals adopted in 2015 (replacing MDGs)
- **Millennium Development Goals (MDGs):** 8 goals, 2000–2015

Quick Memory Tricks

- UN = **1945**, New York, 193 members, 51 founders
- UN Day = **October 24** (Charter IN FORCE) ≠ June 26 (Charter SIGNED)
- ICJ = **The Hague** — not New York
- P5 = **5 Powerful Nations Rule** — USA UK France Russia China

- 6 languages: **AC-EFR-S** = Arabic Chinese English French Russian Spanish
-

SECTION 2: ORGANISATION OF ISLAMIC COOPERATION (OIC)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** Organisation of Islamic Cooperation
- **Old Name (before 2011):** Organisation of the Islamic Conference
- **Abbreviation:** OIC
- **Founded:** 25 September 1969
- **Headquarters:** Jeddah, Saudi Arabia
- **Members:** 57 member states (largest Muslim intergovernmental body)
- **Current Secretary-General:** Hissein Brahim Taha (Chad) — since January 2022
- **Governing Body:** Islamic Summit (Heads of State) + Council of Foreign Ministers

Background & Formation

- Formed in response to the **arson attack on Al-Aqsa Mosque, Jerusalem** on 21 August 1969
- An Israeli extremist set fire to the holy mosque, shocking the Muslim world
- The **First Islamic Summit** was convened in **Rabat, Morocco** on 25 September 1969
- 25 Muslim-majority countries participated in the founding summit
- OIC was formally established to protect Muslim interests globally
- Pakistan is a **founding member** of the OIC

Name Change (2011)

- At the 38th Council of Foreign Ministers meeting in Astana, Kazakhstan (2011)
- Name changed from "Organisation of the Islamic **Conference**" to "Organisation of Islamic **Cooperation**"
- The abbreviation OIC remained the same

Purpose & Objectives

- Strengthen Islamic solidarity among member states
- Safeguard and protect Muslim interests worldwide
- Support the Palestinian cause and liberation of Al-Quds (Jerusalem)
- Promote economic, scientific, and cultural cooperation
- Coordinate positions of Muslim-majority nations in international forums
- Defend sovereignty and territorial integrity of member states

Key OIC Facts

- **57 members** — 2nd largest intergovernmental organization after UN
- OIC Summit (Kings & Heads of State) held every **3 years**
- Council of Foreign Ministers meets annually
- **OIC Charter** adopted at the 3rd Islamic Conference in Jeddah (1972)
- **5 Observer States:** Russia, Bosnia-Herzegovina, Thailand, Central African Republic, Turkish Cypriots

- OIC has permanent observer status at the UN
- OIC Headquarters is in **Jeddah**, NOT Mecca or Riyadh

Pakistan & OIC

- Pakistan is a founding member (1969)
- Pakistan has hosted several OIC summits
- OIC 2nd Summit (1974) was held in **Lahore, Pakistan** — recognized Bangladesh
- Pakistan was suspended from OIC during 1999–2004 after military coup
- OIC has supported Pakistan on the Kashmir issue

Secretary-Generals of OIC (Important for Exams)

Name	Country	Period
Tunku Abdul Rahman	Malaysia	1970–1973
Hassan Touhami	Egypt	1974–1975
Amadou Karim Gaye	Senegal	1975–1979
Habib Chatti	Tunisia	1979–1984
Syed Sharifuddin Pirzada	Pakistan	1985–1988
Hamid Algabid	Niger	1989–1996
Azeddine Laraki	Morocco	1997–2000
Abdelouahed Belkeziz	Morocco	2001–2004
Ekmeleddin İhsanoğlu	Turkey	2005–2014
Iyad Madani	Saudi Arabia	2014–2016
Yousef Al-Othaimeen	Saudi Arabia	2016–2021
Hissein Brahim Taha	Chad	2022–present

Quick Memory Tricks

- OIC = **1969**, Jeddah, 57 members, Al-Aqsa arson trigger
- Jeddah ≠ Mecca ≠ Riyadh — HQ is JEDDAH
- Name changed: Conference → **Cooperation** in **2011**
- Pakistan SG of OIC: **Syed Sharifuddin Pirzada (1985–1988)**
- Pakistan hosted OIC 2nd Summit: **Lahore 1974**

SECTION 3: SOUTH ASIAN ASSOCIATION FOR REGIONAL COOPERATION (SAARC)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation

- **Abbreviation:** SAARC
- **Founded:** 8 December 1985
- **Founded In (City):** Dhaka, Bangladesh (First Summit)
- **Headquarters:** Kathmandu, Nepal
- **Founding Document:** Dhaka Declaration (1985) & SAARC Charter
- **Members:** 8 member states
- **SAARC Secretariat Opened:** 1987 (in Kathmandu)

8 Member States (Must Memorize)

1. Afghanistan (joined 2007 as 8th member)
2. Bangladesh (founding member)
3. Bhutan (founding member)
4. India (founding member)
5. Maldives (founding member)
6. Nepal (founding member)
7. Pakistan (founding member)
8. Sri Lanka (founding member)

Memory Trick: "All Big Bhutan India Maldives Nepal Pakistan Sri lanka" — A-B-B-I-M-N-P-S

Background & Formation

- Idea proposed by **Bangladesh President Ziaur Rahman** in 1980
- Preparatory meetings held from 1981–1985
- SAARC formally established at the **First SAARC Summit, Dhaka, 7–8 December 1985**
- 7 countries signed the founding charter (Afghanistan joined later in 2007)
- Objective: promote regional cooperation in South Asia

Purpose & Objectives

- Promote welfare of people of South Asia and improve quality of life
- Accelerate economic growth, social progress, and cultural development
- Strengthen collective self-reliance among member nations
- Promote active collaboration in economic, social, cultural, technical fields
- Cooperate in agriculture, rural development, environment, health, and education

Key SAARC Facts

- **Guiding Principles:** Non-interference in internal affairs; unanimity for decisions; bilateralism (disputes not discussed in SAARC)
- **SAARC Secretariat:** Opened in Kathmandu on 16 January 1987
- **Observer States:** USA, EU, China, Japan, South Korea, Australia, Iran, Myanmar (9 observers)
- **SAFTA** (South Asian Free Trade Area): Signed January 2004, effective July 2006
- **Last Summit:** 19th SAARC Summit held in Islamabad (2016) — summits stalled since then

- Summits stalled due to India-Pakistan tensions after Uri attack (2016)
- **SAARC Cultural Centre:** Colombo, Sri Lanka
- **SAARC Agricultural Centre:** Dhaka, Bangladesh

SAARC Summits in Pakistan

- **4th Summit:** Islamabad, 1988
- **12th Summit:** Islamabad, 2004
- **19th Summit:** Islamabad, 2016 (last held summit)

SAFTA — South Asian Free Trade Area

- Signed: **January 6, 2004** at 12th SAARC Summit, Islamabad
- Came into force: **July 1, 2006**
- Goal: reduce customs duties on trade among SAARC member nations
- Eventually aims to create a SAARC common market

Quick Memory Tricks

- SAARC = **1985**, Kathmandu HQ, Founded in Dhaka
- 8 members (Afghanistan joined last in 2007)
- SAFTA = **2004** signed | **2006** effective
- SAARC Secretariat opened **1987** (not 1985)
- HQ: **Kathmandu** | Founded: **Dhaka** (K≠D)

SECTION 4: NORTH ATLANTIC TREATY ORGANIZATION (NATO)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** North Atlantic Treaty Organization
- **Abbreviation:** NATO
- **Founded:** 4 April 1949
- **Treaty:** North Atlantic Treaty (also called Washington Treaty)
- **Treaty Signed In:** Washington D.C., USA
- **Headquarters:** Brussels, Belgium (since 1967)
- **Original HQ:** Paris, France (1952-1967)
- **Members:** 32 member states (as of 2024)
- **Current Secretary-General:** Mark Rutte (Netherlands) — since October 2024
- **Previous Secretary-General:** Jens Stoltenberg (Norway) — 2014 to 2024

Background & Formation

- Formed during the Cold War as a collective defence alliance against Soviet threat
- 12 founding nations signed the Washington Treaty on 4 April 1949
- Based on the principle of collective defence (Article 5)
- Counterpart to Warsaw Pact (Soviet-led military alliance, 1955-1991)

12 Founding Members of NATO

1. United States
2. United Kingdom
3. France
4. Canada
5. Belgium
6. Netherlands
7. Luxembourg
8. Norway
9. Denmark
10. Iceland
11. Italy
12. Portugal

Key NATO Articles

- **Article 5:** Collective defence — an attack on one NATO member = attack on all
- **Article 6:** Defines geographic scope of collective defence
- **Article 10:** Allows invitation of new members by unanimous consent

NATO Headquarters History

- **1949–1952:** London, UK (provisional)
- **1952–1967:** Paris, France (Palais de Chaillot)
- **1967–present:** Brussels, Belgium (France under de Gaulle withdrew from military command)

Newest NATO Members

Country	Year Joined
Finland	April 4, 2023
Sweden	March 7, 2024
North Macedonia	2020
Montenegro	2017

NATO & Afghanistan

- NATO-led **ISAF (International Security Assistance Force)** operated in Afghanistan 2001–2014
- **Resolute Support Mission** replaced ISAF 2015–2021
- Pakistan cooperated with NATO during this period as a non-member partner

Key NATO Operations

- Operation Allied Force (Yugoslavia, 1999)
- Operation Enduring Freedom (Afghanistan, 2001)

- Operation Unified Protector (Libya, 2011)
- Enhanced Forward Presence (Eastern Europe, ongoing since 2017)

Quick Memory Tricks

- NATO = **1949**, Brussels HQ, 32 members
- Treaty signed: **Washington D.C.** → HQ: **Brussels** (different cities!)
- Article 5 = "**Attack one, attack all**"
- Old HQ: **Paris** → New HQ: **Brussels** (moved 1967)
- SG: **Mark Rutte** (Netherlands, since Oct 2024)

SECTION 5: WORLD TRADE ORGANIZATION (WTO)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** World Trade Organization
- **Abbreviation:** WTO
- **Founded:** 1 January 1995
- **Headquarters:** Geneva, Switzerland
- **Replaced:** GATT (General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade, 1947)
- **Creating Agreement:** Marrakesh Agreement (signed April 15, 1994)
- **Members:** 164+ member states
- **Current Director-General:** Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala (Nigeria) — since March 1, 2021
- **Head Title:** Director-General (NOT Secretary-General)

Background & Formation

- GATT (1947) was an informal multilateral agreement on trade — not a formal organization
- Uruguay Round of trade negotiations (1986–1994) led to creation of WTO
- Marrakesh Agreement signed in Marrakesh, Morocco on April 15, 1994
- WTO officially came into existence on January 1, 1995
- WTO is the successor and replacement of GATT

GATT vs WTO

Feature	GATT (1947)	WTO (1995)
Year	1947	1995
Nature	Informal agreement	Formal organization
Scope	Goods only	Goods, services, intellectual property
Dispute Settlement	Weak	Strong, binding
Membership	Contracting Parties	Member states

Purpose & Objectives

- Regulate and facilitate international trade between nations
- Provide a forum for trade negotiations
- Handle trade disputes between members through binding dispute settlement
- Ensure trade flows as smoothly, predictably, and freely as possible
- Promote free trade and reduce trade barriers (tariffs, quotas)

Key WTO Principles

1. **MFN (Most Favoured Nation):** Treat all WTO members equally in trade
2. **National Treatment:** Don't discriminate between domestic and foreign goods
3. **Free Trade:** Lower barriers through negotiation
4. **Predictability:** Bind tariff rates; no sudden changes
5. **Fair Competition:** Discourage unfair practices (dumping, subsidies)

WTO Trade Rounds

Round	Location	Year
Geneva Round	Geneva	1947
Kennedy Round	Geneva	1964-1967
Tokyo Round	Tokyo	1973-1979
Uruguay Round	Multiple	1986-1994 (created WTO)
Doha Round	Doha, Qatar	2001-ongoing (stalled)

Key Facts

- **Doha Development Agenda:** Launched November 2001 in Doha, Qatar
- **Okonjo-Iweala:** First woman AND first African to head WTO (2021)
- **Pakistan:** WTO founding member since January 1, 1995
- **Dispute Settlement:** WTO's strongest mechanism — rulings are binding
- **TRIPS:** Trade-Related Intellectual Property Rights — WTO agreement

Quick Memory Tricks

- WTO = **1995**, Geneva, replaced GATT (1947)
 - Marrakesh Agreement 1994 → WTO started **Jan 1, 1995**
 - DG title = **Director-General** (not SG, not MD, not President)
 - Okonjo-Iweala = **first female + first African** DG (2021)
 - GATT gap: 1947 to 1995 = **48 years**
-

SECTION 6: INTERNATIONAL MONETARY FUND (IMF)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** International Monetary Fund
- **Abbreviation:** IMF
- **Conceived:** July 1944 (Bretton Woods Conference)
- **Articles of Agreement Signed:** December 27, 1945
- **Operations Began:** March 1947
- **Headquarters:** Washington D.C., USA
- **Members:** 190 member states
- **Head Title:** Managing Director (NOT Secretary-General, NOT President)
- **Current Managing Director:** Kristalina Georgieva (Bulgaria) — since October 2019
- **Sister Organization:** World Bank Group

Bretton Woods Conference (1944)

- Held in **Bretton Woods, New Hampshire, USA** in July 1944
- Created BOTH the IMF and the World Bank (IBRD)
- 44 allied nations participated
- Aimed to rebuild the international monetary system after WWII
- Established the **Bretton Woods System** of fixed exchange rates (until 1971)

Purpose & Objectives

- Promote global monetary cooperation
- Ensure exchange rate stability
- Facilitate balanced growth of international trade
- Provide resources to help members with balance-of-payments difficulties
- Reduce poverty and promote employment
- Surveillance of members' economic policies

Key IMF Concepts

- **SDR (Special Drawing Rights):** International reserve asset created by IMF in 1969; based on basket of 5 currencies (USD, EUR, CNY, JPY, GBP)
- **Quota System:** Each member assigned a quota based on economic size — determines voting power and borrowing capacity
- **Conditionality:** IMF attaches economic reform conditions to loans
- **Stand-By Arrangement (SBA):** Short-term IMF loan program for balance-of-payments crises

IMF Managing Directors (Recent)

Name	Country	Period
Rodrigo de Rato	Spain	2004-2007
Dominique Strauss-Kahn	France	2007-2011

Name	Country	Period
Christine Lagarde	France	2011–2019
Kristalina Georgieva	Bulgaria	2019–present

IMF & Pakistan

- Pakistan has received multiple IMF bailout programs
- Programs are typically Extended Fund Facility (EFF) or Stand-By Arrangement (SBA)
- Conditionalties include: currency devaluation, subsidy removal, tax reforms
- Pakistan has been one of the most frequent IMF borrowers

Quick Memory Tricks

- IMF = **1944** Bretton Woods, **Washington D.C.**, MD Georgieva
- Head title: **Managing Director** (Europeans traditionally hold this)
- SDR = **Special Drawing Rights** (IMF's own reserve currency)
- IMF = **monetary stability** | World Bank = **development projects**
- Both IMF & World Bank = **Washington D.C.** | both created **1944**

SECTION 7: WORLD BANK

Basic Information

- **Formal Name:** International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)
- **Common Name:** World Bank
- **Founded:** 1944 (Bretton Woods); operations began 1946
- **Headquarters:** Washington D.C., USA
- **Head Title:** President (NOT Managing Director)
- **Current President:** Ajay Banga (Indian-American) — since June 2, 2023
- **Members (IBRD):** 189 member states
- **Goal:** End extreme poverty; boost shared prosperity

World Bank Group — 5 Institutions

Institution	Full Name	Focus
IBRD	Intl Bank for Reconstruction & Development	Loans to middle-income countries
IDA	International Development Association	Grants/loans to poorest countries
IFC	International Finance Corporation	Private sector investment
MIGA	Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency	Investment guarantees
ICSID	Intl Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes	Dispute resolution

Background & Formation

- Created at the Bretton Woods Conference, July 1944 alongside IMF
- Originally designed to help rebuild post-WWII Europe (hence "Reconstruction")
- Focus shifted to developing countries in later decades
- World Bank provides longer-term development loans (unlike IMF's short-term)

Purpose & Objectives

- Provide financial and technical assistance to developing countries
- Fund infrastructure (roads, dams, power plants), education, and health
- Reduce poverty and promote sustainable development
- Support private sector development in developing nations

Key World Bank Facts

- **By Convention:** World Bank President is always an American citizen
- **IDA:** Provides zero-interest or very low-interest loans to world's poorest nations
- **World Bank Reports:** World Development Report (annual); Doing Business Report
- **Ajay Banga:** 14th President; former CEO of Mastercard; first Indian-American president
- **World Bank Day:** Not a formal day; operates year-round

IMF vs World Bank — Key Difference

Feature	IMF	World Bank
Full Name	International Monetary Fund	IBRD
Focus	Monetary/currency stability	Development projects
Loans	Short-term	Long-term
Head Title	Managing Director	President
Head Nationality	European (convention)	American (convention)
Created	Bretton Woods 1944	Bretton Woods 1944
HQ	Washington D.C.	Washington D.C.

Quick Memory Tricks

- World Bank = **1944**, Washington D.C., President = Ajay Banga
- IBRD = **formal name** of World Bank
- 5 arms: **IBRD IDA IFC MIGA ICSID**
- President = **American** | MD (IMF) = **European** (by convention)

SECTION 8: EUROPEAN UNION (EU)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** European Union
- **Abbreviation:** EU
- **Formally Established:** 1 November 1993 (Maastricht Treaty)
- **Predecessor:** European Economic Community (EEC) — Treaty of Rome, 1957
- **Main Headquarters:** Brussels, Belgium
- **European Parliament:** Strasbourg, France
- **Court of Justice:** Luxembourg
- **Members:** 27 member states (after Brexit in 2020)
- **Commission President:** Ursula von der Leyen (Germany) — since 2019, reappointed 2024
- **Currency:** Euro (€) — used by 20 of 27 EU members (Eurozone)

Historical Evolution of EU

Year	Event
1951	Treaty of Paris — created ECSC (European Coal & Steel Community) by 6 nations
1957	Treaty of Rome — created EEC and Euratom
1967	Merger Treaty — merged ECSC, EEC, Euratom into EC
1986	Single European Act — created Single Market
1992	Maastricht Treaty signed (February 7)
1993	EU formally established (November 1)
1995	Schengen Area operational
1999	Euro introduced (electronic/financial)
2002	Euro physical notes & coins launched
2004	Largest single expansion — 10 countries joined
2007	Lisbon Treaty signed (reformed EU)
2012	EU awarded Nobel Peace Prize
2016	UK Brexit referendum (June 23)
2020	UK officially leaves EU (January 31)

6 Founding EEC Members (1957)

1. France
2. West Germany
3. Italy
4. Belgium
5. Netherlands
6. Luxembourg

Memory Trick: "France Germany Italy Belux" — FGIB + Netherlands + Luxembourg

Brexit — UK's Exit from EU

- **Referendum:** June 23, 2016 — 52% voted Leave
- **Triggering Article 50:** March 29, 2017
- **Official Departure:** January 31, 2020
- **Transition Period Ended:** December 31, 2020
- After Brexit: EU has **27 members** (was 28 with UK)

EU Key Institutions

Institution	Location	Role
European Commission	Brussels	Executive body; proposes legislation
European Parliament	Strasbourg / Brussels	Legislative; directly elected
European Council	Brussels	Heads of State meetings; sets direction
Council of EU	Brussels	Ministers from each country; legislates
Court of Justice	Luxembourg	Interprets EU law
European Central Bank	Frankfurt, Germany	Manages Euro/monetary policy

Euro Currency

- **Introduction (electronic):** January 1, 1999
- **Physical Notes & Coins:** January 1, 2002
- **Eurozone:** 20 of 27 EU members use Euro
- Countries NOT using Euro (notable): Sweden, Denmark, Poland, Hungary, Czech Republic

Schengen Area

- **Agreement Signed:** 1985 in Schengen, Luxembourg
- Allows passport-free travel across member countries
- 27 countries in Schengen Area (not identical to EU membership — some non-EU countries included)

Quick Memory Tricks

- EU = **1993** (Maastricht) | Predecessor EEC = **1957** (Rome)
 - HQ Brussels | Parliament **Strasbourg** | Court **Luxembourg**
 - **27 members** after Brexit (UK left Jan 31, **2020**)
 - Euro physical = **2002** | electronic = **1999**
 - 6 founders: France Germany Italy Belgium Netherlands Luxembourg
-

SECTION 9: ASSOCIATION OF SOUTHEAST ASIAN NATIONS (ASEAN)

Basic Information

- **Full Name:** Association of Southeast Asian Nations
- **Abbreviation:** ASEAN
- **Founded:** 8 August 1967
- **Founding Declaration:** Bangkok Declaration
- **Founded In:** Bangkok, Thailand
- **Headquarters:** Jakarta, Indonesia
- **Members:** 10 member states
- **Current Secretary-General:** Kao Kim Hourn (Cambodia) — since January 2023
- **ASEAN Day:** 8 August (anniversary of Bangkok Declaration)

5 Founding Members (Bangkok Declaration, 1967)

1. Indonesia
2. Malaysia
3. Philippines
4. Singapore
5. Thailand

Memory Trick: IMPS-T = Indonesia Malaysia Philippines Singapore Thailand

All 10 Current Members

Country	Year Joined
Indonesia	1967 (founder)
Malaysia	1967 (founder)
Philippines	1967 (founder)
Singapore	1967 (founder)
Thailand	1967 (founder)
Brunei Darussalam	1984
Vietnam	1995
Laos	1997
Myanmar	1997
Cambodia	1999

Background & Formation

- Established during Cold War — partly to counter communist influence in SE Asia
- Bangkok Declaration signed August 8, 1967 by foreign ministers of 5 founding nations
- Indonesia's Adam Malik, Malaysia's Tun Abdul Razak among key founders

- HQ established in Jakarta, Indonesia
- ASEAN Charter adopted at 13th Summit in Singapore (2007), in force December 2008

Purpose & Objectives

- Promote economic growth, social progress, and cultural development
- Promote regional peace and stability
- Provide platform for cooperation on trade, security, and political issues
- Accelerate economic integration in Southeast Asia

Key ASEAN Facts

- **ASEAN Charter:** Adopted 2007 (in force 2008) — gave ASEAN legal personality
- **AFTA (ASEAN Free Trade Area):** Signed 1992; aims to eliminate tariffs among members
- **ASEAN Community:** Established 2015 with 3 pillars: Political-Security, Economic, Socio-Cultural
- **RCEP:** Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership — signed November 2020 (includes ASEAN + China, Japan, South Korea, Australia, New Zealand)
- **ASEAN Way:** Non-interference in domestic affairs; consensus-based decision making

ASEAN Summits & Pakistan

- Pakistan is NOT a member of ASEAN (it's in South Asia, not Southeast Asia)
- Pakistan has no formal ASEAN membership; participates as dialogue partner in some forums
- Pakistan is part of SAARC which covers South Asia

Quick Memory Tricks

- ASEAN = **1967**, Jakarta HQ, founded in **Bangkok**
- 5 founders = **IMPS-T** (Indonesia Malaysia Philippines Singapore Thailand)
- 10 members now; **Brunei** 1st to join after founding (1984)
- ASEAN Charter = **2007** | AFTA = **1992** | RCEP = **2020**
- ASEAN Day = **August 8**

SECTION 10: MASTER COMPARISON TABLE

Org	Full Name	Year	HQ City	Country	Head Title	Current Head	Members
UN	United Nations	1945	New York	USA	Secretary-General	António Guterres	193
OIC	Org. of Islamic Cooperation	1969	Jeddah	Saudi Arabia	Secretary-General	Hissein Brahim Taha	57
SAARC	S. Asian Assoc. for	1985	Kathmandu	Nepal	Secretary-General	Rotational	8

Org	Full Name	Year	HQ City	Country	Head Title	Current Head	Members
	Reg. Cooperation						
NATO	North Atlantic Treaty Org.	1949	Brussels	Belgium	Secretary-General	Mark Rutte	32
WTO	World Trade Organization	1995	Geneva	Switzerland	Director-General	Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala	164+
IMF	International Monetary Fund	1944	Washington D.C.	USA	Managing Director	Kristalina Georgieva	190
WB	World Bank (IBRD)	1944	Washington D.C.	USA	President	Ajay Banga	189
EU	European Union	1993	Brussels	Belgium	Commission President	Ursula von der Leyen	27
ASEAN	Assoc. of SE Asian Nations	1967	Jakarta	Indonesia	Secretary-General	Kao Kim Hourn	10

SECTION 11: HQ GROUPINGS (FOR MATCHING MCQs)

New York, USA

- UN (United Nations) — main HQ
- UNICEF, UNDP, UN Women

Washington D.C., USA

- IMF (International Monetary Fund)
- World Bank (IBRD)
- Both created at Bretton Woods 1944

Geneva, Switzerland

- WTO (World Trade Organization)
- WHO (World Health Organization)
- ILO (International Labour Organization)
- UNHCR (UN High Commissioner for Refugees)
- WEF (World Economic Forum — actually Davos/Geneva)
- UNCTAD

Brussels, Belgium

- NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization)
- EU (European Union — Commission & Council)

Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

- OIC (Organisation of Islamic Cooperation)

Kathmandu, Nepal

- SAARC (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation)

Jakarta, Indonesia

- ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations)

The Hague, Netherlands

- ICJ (International Court of Justice — UN organ)
- ICC (International Criminal Court — separate from UN)

Rome, Italy

- FAO (Food & Agriculture Organization)
- WFP (World Food Programme)
- IFAD (International Fund for Agricultural Development)

Paris, France

- UNESCO (UN Educational, Scientific & Cultural Organization)
- OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation & Development)

Vienna, Austria

- IAEA (International Atomic Energy Agency)
- UNIDO (UN Industrial Development Organization)
- OPEC (Organization of Petroleum Exporting Countries)

Nairobi, Kenya

- UNEP (UN Environment Programme)
- UN-Habitat

SECTION 12: CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER (FOUNDING YEARS)

1. **1944** — IMF (conceived at Bretton Woods)
2. **1944** — World Bank/IBRD (conceived at Bretton Woods)
3. **1945** — UN (October 24)
4. **1947** — GATT (predecessor to WTO)
5. **1948** — WHO, OAS
6. **1949** — NATO (April 4)

7. **1957** — EEC — Treaty of Rome (EU predecessor)
8. **1960** — OPEC
9. **1961** — NAM (Non-Aligned Movement)
10. **1963** — OAU (now African Union)
11. **1967** — ASEAN (August 8)
12. **1969** — OIC (September 25)
13. **1985** — SAARC (December 8)
14. **1991** — CIS (Commonwealth of Independent States)
15. **1993** — EU formally (Maastricht Treaty, November 1)
16. **1995** — WTO (January 1, replaced GATT)

SECTION 13: HEAD TITLE QUICK REFERENCE

Title	Organizations
Secretary-General	UN, OIC, SAARC, NATO, ASEAN, Commonwealth, SCO
Managing Director	IMF only
President	World Bank only
Director-General	WTO, WHO, UNESCO, FAO, IAEA
Commission President	EU (European Commission)

SECTION 14: COMMON TRAP QUESTIONS & CORRECT ANSWERS

1. **Q: Where was the UN Charter signed?** A: San Francisco, USA (June 26, 1945) — NOT New York
2. **Q: When is UN Day celebrated?** A: October 24 — when Charter came INTO FORCE
3. **Q: Where is ICJ?** A: The Hague, Netherlands — NOT New York
4. **Q: OIC HQ?** A: Jeddah, Saudi Arabia — NOT Mecca, NOT Riyadh
5. **Q: SAARC was founded in which city?** A: Dhaka, Bangladesh — HQ is in Kathmandu, Nepal (different!)
6. **Q: NATO treaty signed where?** A: Washington D.C. — HQ is in Brussels (different!)
7. **Q: WTO replaced which organization?** A: GATT (1947) — WTO established 1995
8. **Q: IMF head title?** A: Managing Director — NOT Secretary-General
9. **Q: World Bank formal name?** A: IBRD (International Bank for Reconstruction and Development)
10. **Q: EU members after Brexit?** A: 27 (UK left January 31, 2020)
11. **Q: Euro physical notes launched?** A: January 1, 2002 (electronic since 1999)
12. **Q: ASEAN founded in?** A: Bangkok, Thailand — HQ is in Jakarta, Indonesia (different!)
13. **Q: NATO's original HQ?** A: Paris, France (moved to Brussels in 1967)
14. **Q: How many countries founded NATO?** A: 12 founding nations
15. **Q: Afghanistan joined SAARC in?** A: 2007 (as 8th member)

Notes prepared for NotebookLM — ETEA, KPPSC, FPSC, FIA, NTS, CSS, PMS Last
Updated: 2025